

CULTURE AND IMPERIALISM by EDWARD SAID

BOOK REVIEW

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Edward Said tells us about the double standards of European countries in Asia and Africa. In this story, Edward has done a very good job at exposing the clever, strong and rich countries how they impose their powers on the poor countries due to greed, hatred and lust for power. Also there are mentions of how the progressive and developed nations went to poor countries to take over them. The powerful countries exploited the rights, cultural rights, religious rights and economic conditions of the poor countries. The rich countries took the control of the poor countries. Countries like Britain, France and America just wanted to increase their power by invading these poor countries. They nullified people's rights.

Also according to Edward before British and France there used to be an era in which Rome was there and there was Baghdad and Muslim Rule. There are mentions of Ottoman Empire and Constantinople were ruling these were some very big powers that used to rule.

In England and France there was industrial revolution which compelled these nations to move out of their territories and explore the unknown areas of Asia and Africa. By doing so, they were able to find undeveloped nations which had fertile land which was very helpful for their industries as it would aid them in growing, then they found raw materials through which they made a lot of economy by selling them to the rich individuals of the England and France. They made the locals their servants and ruled over them over their land due to their lack of education they had to face a lot of trouble from the developed nations. They opted for a divide and rule policy in which they divided the areas to small regions and ruled over them to allow for easy ruling.

The rich countries made the locals of the poor nations their mental slaves by telling them that they didn't know anything they were uneducated and had no

manners. Due to this, the locals had to follow their acts and consider them as role models for themselves. There was actual trading of slaves in these countries. The rich people wanted the expensive ivory, trunks of elephants and expensive things like these from these poor states. These countries want to let these poor nations live in the dark and let them remain lack of educated and illiterate so that they always depend on these super powers and remain them unknown about how they are not advancing whereas these developed nations rule over these countries by the help of their technology for centuries.

There is a sense of pride when you control over the people which slowly turns into desire and eventually turns into lust for power. This in turns leads to colonialism. The same happened with these powerful nations. Edward tells us that till 19th century, there were two super powers which controlled over the world and had setup their colonies all over the world such as Asia, Africa and Latin America countries. They had established their governments over there and started to take out raw materials from their lands and send them to their countries. The raw materials found in the superior countries lands was not up to the standard and hence they had to exploit the resources of these poor countries.

The rich countries did intellectual cruelty on these nations by saying that we are bringing reforms to your country which will help your country grow but in reality it did the exact opposite of it and ate the minor people's rights. Edward also tells these nations think of themselves more far superior than others and to them humanity is nothing and they believe in caste, color, religion and politics. These countries have come to rule and hence are full of stubbornness. These influential countries impose their religion, literature, politics, culture, and values on the poor countries and change their cultures with their cultures.

He also told about that an empire is a relationship in which one country rules over another country by force, economic, cultural and social dependence.

There were two countries, one was the America the other one was the USSR and after the war there was only one country known the America and the world was become to be known as uni-polar before which it was known as multi-polar. This resulted in a new type of colonization and America was on top of the list.

After Second World War, in 1950s these colonized people started to de-colonize their areas because they were getting weaker and losing the grip on these areas.

The powerful people loot the natural resources of weak countries and bring them to their industries and boost their economy and prosper this is a short way to describe Imperialism which happened due to lust for power and lack of natural resources.

Edward also talks about his theory white man burden according to which a white man has to everywhere with the consent of forcibly without the consent of the natives and teach them his own way of education, political system.

According to Edward the most horrible type of colonialism is new colonialism after 1991 after the loss of USSR there was only one super power left which controlled over all the people through media, economic policies and controlled over all nations such as the problems caused in Afghanistan, Iraq and Palestine according to Edward Said, America is to be blamed for all these reasons.

Edward also discusses the post-colonial writings of many writers and criticizes them. These writers Chinua Achebe (*Things Fall Apart*), Joseph Conrad (*Heart of Darkness*) and Jane Austen (*Mansfield Park*) also tell about these super power how they are exploiting the rights of these poor nations and ruling over them. These writers reveal the true identities behind these masks and tell about their cruelty and lust for power.

Edward states that people should be given freedom to live and we should encourage humanity and help in doing humanitarian acts and helping people and live as a strong nation and discourage nationalism.